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Yes the cynic in you must be dying to say "who watches DVDs anyway".

But believe it or not - and the connoisseurs would agree with this one - there is no other way to really enjoy a good film other than on a DVD player connected to a large screen LCD. Though many of us do watch movies on a largish computer screen, the kind of immersive experience a player and home theatre combo can give remains unmatched. You can sit back, relax and take

in the experience with friends and family. Besides, you can't put a price tag on the value of touch and feel and the ownership of a sizeable DVD collection.

The product landscape has changed a lot since the last time we did this comparison test. When USB support was an exception, now it has become the norm. Additional features such as CD ripping, subtitle support and copying from disk have increased the functionality of these players. Furthermore, Blu-ray players have under-cut the 10k price point, which makes them an

amazingly viable option for upping your taste for HD entertainment. For this comparison we got our hands on five Blu-ray players and eight DVD players

DVD Players

We received players from four popular brands that represented a cross section of everything available in the market - from basic functionality to the whole bells and whistles. Every brand had a couple of low end offerings and one high end model with a slightly enhanced price tag and some more features thrown in - such as maybe an HDMI connect.

Performance

When you look at a buying decision quality is and should be your topmost concern. The lower end products although cheap were not at all good when it came to rendering video, which is what a DVD player should do in the first place. Soyer, a relatively lesser known brand sent us three models. They come with a warranty and figure in the same league as Moserbaer i.e. a little better off than unbranded Chinese stuff. The Soyer 3203C and D2601 were very little apart from each other in terms of performance. They did however look dis-

Sit back, relax!

Connected to a decent TV, DVD players can be more fun than you'd imagine. Besides, isn't it time you took a serious look at Blu-rays as a viable option?

